

Lee-Ann Vidal-Covas | PhD

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Education

- 2025 **Ph.D.**, *Boston University*, Linguistics
Dissertation: *Covariation & salience in linguistic contact: a sociophonetic study of liquid variation in Boston Spanish*
Committee: Daniel G. Erker (Chair), Neil J. Myler & Kate Lynn Lindsey
- 2021 **M.A.**, *Boston University*, Linguistics
- 2013 **M.A.**, *Louisiana State University*, Hispanic Studies/Spanish Linguistics
Thesis: *El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico*
Committee: Rafael Orozco, Jeremy King & Andrea Morris
- 2011 **B.A.**, *Louisiana State University*, Hispanic Studies and Literatures
- 2020 **The New York - St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition, and Culture**, Coursework in writing systems and phonology, morphology, experimental linguistics & syntax

Publications

Refereed Journal Articles

- 2024 Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Variation, Contact, and Change in Boston Spanish: How social meaning shapes stylistic practice and bilingual optimization. *Studies in Hispanic and Lusophone Linguistics*, 17(2), 223–249. [DOI]

Refereed Proceedings

- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** ¿Va primero el verbo? or ¿El sujeto va primero?: Subject-verb order in Latin American Spanish. *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America*, 8(1), Article 5542, pp. 1–17. [DOI]
- 2014 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Los efectos condicionantes del verbo en el uso variable de los pronombres personales de sujeto. *Actas del XVII Congreso Internacional de la Asociación de Lingüística y Filología de la América Latina*, pp. 1–17.

Contributions to Edited Volumes (invited)

- 2022 Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** What we say when we say nothing at all: Clues to contact-induced language change in Spanish conversational pause-fillers. *Estudios del Observatorio / Observatorio Studies*, 80, pp. 1–29.
- Erker, Daniel G. & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Qué decimos cuando no decimos nada: Claves del cambio lingüístico inducido por contacto en las pausas llenas del español conversacional. *Estudios del Observatorio / Observatorio Studies*, 80, pp. 1–31.

Edited Volumes

- 2021 Dionne, Danielle & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** (Eds). *Proceedings of the 45th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*. Somerville, MA, Cascadilla Press.

Other Publications

- 2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico. *LSU Master's Theses*, 3876. [DOI]

Presentations

Refereed Papers

- 2024 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** How Salience Influences Dialectal Persistence and Covariation: Insights from Boston's Spanish-Speaking Community, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation* 52, Miami, FL, Nov 7th – 9th.
- Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Investigating Salience and Ideologies in Greater Boston: a Sociophonetic Analysis of Liquid Variation, *International Symposium on Language Ideologies and Attitudes*, Palma de Mallorca, Spain, October 17th – 19th.
- Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Riding the Waves of Salience: Exploring Spanish Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *LSA 2024*, NYC, New York, January 4th – 7th.

- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Saliency of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation* 51, NYC, New York, October 13th – 15th.
- 2014 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** The Verb as a Predictor of Variable Pronominal Use in Spanish, *New Ways of Analyzing Variation* 43, Chicago, Illinois, October 23rd – 26th.
 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Los efectos condicionantes del verbo en el uso variable de los pronombres personales de sujeto, *The Association of Linguistics and Philology Latin America Conference*, Paraíba, João Pessoa, Brazil, July 14th – 19th.
 Orozco, R., Méndez Vallejo, Catalina, & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Verb-related Constraints on Variable Pronominal Use: Do we have all the Answers?, *7th International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics*, Madison, Wisconsin, April 3rd – 5th.
 Orozco, Rafael; Méndez Vallejo, Catalina; & **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** The Effects of Verb Semantics on Pronominal Expression: A Preliminary Study, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, Baton Rouge, Louisiana, Feb 27th - March 1st.
Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M. El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, Baton Rouge, LA, Feb 27th – March 1st.
- 2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Variable use of subject pronouns in the Spanish in Louisiana, *2nd Graduate Symposium Universidad de Puerto Rico*, Río Piedras, Puerto Rico, April.
Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M. & Linder, Cali. Variable use of subject pronouns in Spanish, *Southeastern Conference on Linguistics LXXX*, Spartanburg, South Carolina, April 4th – 6th.

Invited Talks

- 2024 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Salient Features, Strong Identities: Social Meaning and Stylistic Choices in Boston Spanish, *World Languages, Literatures & Cultures Department - Louisiana State University*, New Orleans, LA, Dec 3rd.
- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Saliency of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *Linguistics Program - Northeastern University*, Boston, MA, March 23rd.
- 2020 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Guest Lecture: English/Spanish Contrastive Phonology & Filled Pauses, *Intro to Sounds - Boston University*, Boston, MA, October 15th.
- 2017 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Teaching Foreign Language in the 21st Century Classroom, *Louisiana Education Technology Consortium*, Baton Rouge, LA, March.

Refereed Posters

- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** ¿Va primero el verbo OR El sujeto va primero?: Subject-Verb order in Latin American Spanish, *LSA 2023*, Denver, CO, January 5th– 8th.
- 2021 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Filled pauses as a site of language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians, *LSA 2021*, Virtual, January 9th.

Campus/Departmental Talks

- 2025 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Covariation & saliency in linguistic contact: a sociophonetic study of liquid variation in Boston Spanish, *Dissertation Defense - Boston University*, Boston, MA, April 7th.
- 2023 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Making a Splash: The Saliency of Liquid Variation among Boston Spanish speakers, *Graduate Research Forum - Boston University*, Boston, MA, March 20th.
- 2020 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** Filled pauses as a site of language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians, *Graduate Research Forum - Boston University*, Virtual, December 2nd.
- 2013 **Vidal-Covas, Lee-Ann M.** El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico, *LSU Spanish Roundtable*, Baton Rouge, LA, October.

Honors and Awards

- 2019 **Student-Nominated Teaching Appreciation Award**, *St. Joseph's Academy*, Baton Rouge, Student-nominated recognition acknowledging positive academic and personal impact
- April 2013 **Graduate Presentation Award**, *2nd Graduate Symposium*, Universidad de Puerto Rico–Río Piedras, Awarded for outstanding conference presentation (USD 200)

Grants and Fellowships

Fellowships and Research Grants

- Fall – Spring 2023 – 2024 **Graduate Student Fellowship**, *Boston University GRS & Office of the Provost*
tuition + stipend
- Spring 2019, 2022 – 2023 **Graduate Student Fellowship**, *Boston University Linguistics Department*
tuition + stipend
- Sum–Fall 2019, Sm 2020–F 2021 **Research Fellowship**, *Boston University Linguistics Department*
tuition + stipend
- Fall 2018, Spring 2020 **Teaching Fellowship**, *Boston University Linguistics Department*
tuition + stipend
- Spring 2021 **Graduate Research Grant**, *Boston University Linguistics Department*, USD 1,000
- 2016 – 2017 **21st Century Classroom Research Grant**, *Saint Joseph's Academy*, USD 10,000
- Spring 2012 – Fall 2013 **Teaching Fellowship**, *Louisiana State University Foreign Languages and Literatures Department*
tuition + stipend

Conference Travel and Registration Awards

- 2023–2024 **Conference Travel Grants**, *Boston University Linguistics Department & Graduate Student Organization*, supported research dissemination at national and international conferences, Total awarded: USD ≈4,200
- October 2024 **Student Registration Award**, *IDEOLING Organizing Committee*, *Fundació Universitat Empresa de les Illes Balears*, EUR 100
- Jan 2021 **LSA Registration Award**, *Committee on Ethnic Diversity in Linguistics*, *Linguistic Society of America*
- 2013 **Conference Travel Grants**, *Louisiana State University*, supported research dissemination at national and international conferences, Total awarded: USD ≈1,500

Research Experience

Graduate Student Researcher

- 2021 – 2025 **Dissertation**
Covariation & Saliency in Linguistic Contact: A Sociophonetic Study of Liquid Variation in Spanish in Boston
Committee: Daniel G. Erker (Chair), Neil J. Myler & Kate Lynn Lindsey
- 2020 – 2021 **2nd Ph.D. Qualifying Paper**
Subject-Verb Order in Latin American Spanish
Committee: Neil J. Myler (1st Reader), Daniel G. Erker, & Paul Hagstrom
- 2019 – 2020 **1st Ph.D. Qualifying Paper**
Filled Pauses as a site of dialectal and language contact among Spanish-speaking Bostonians
Committee: Daniel G. Erker (1st Reader), Neil J. Myler, & Jon Barnes
- 2011 – 2013 **M.A. Thesis**
El uso variable de los pronombres sujetos en el castellano puertorriqueño hablado en Luisiana y Puerto Rico
Committee: Rafael Orozco (Chair), Jeremy King, & Andrea Morris

Research Assistantships

- 2018 – 2025 **Sociolinguistics Lab**, *Spanish in Boston Project*, Directed by Daniel G. Erker
- 2020 – 2021 **Structures of Under-researched Languages Lab**, *The Mirror Principle Violations Project*, Directed by Neil Myler

Linguistic Fieldwork

- 2012 – 2013 **Puerto Rican Spanish**, in Puerto Rico (DEC – JAN)
in Louisiana

Teaching Experience

Boston University

- Fall 2021 **Language and Music**, *CAS LX 120*
Grader for Daniel G. Erker
- Fall 2020 **Introduction to Sound Systems**, *CAS LX 301/601*
Course Assistant for Kate Lynn Lindsey
- Fall 2018 & Spring 2020 **Say what? Accents, Dialects, and Society**, *CAS LX 110*
Teaching Fellow for Neil J. Myler

Academy of the Sacred Heart (Middle School)

2017 – 2018 **Introductory Spanish & Basic Technology**
Instructor of Record

Saint Joseph's Academy (High School)

2014 – 2017 **Elementary Spanish I & II; Computer & Software Orientation**
Instructor of Record

Louisiana State University

2012 – 2013 **Elementary Spanish I & II, Span 1101 & 1102**
Instructor of Record

Service

To the Department

2021 – 2022 **Graduate Student Organizer**, *Linguistics Department Colloquium Series*, Boston University
Summer 2019 **Lab Manager**, *Sociolinguistics Lab*, Boston University

To the Discipline: Committee

2020 **Co-Organizer**, *45th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*
Sponsorship Chair, *45th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*
2019 **Volunteer Chair**, *44th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*

To the Discipline: Other Work

2021 **Panelist**, *Virtual Open House for MA/PhD Linguistics Programs*, Boston University, December 13th
Volunteer, *95th Annual Meeting Linguistic Society of America (LSA2021)*, Boston University, January
2020 **Panelist**, *Panel on PhD Applications*, Boston University, November 4th
Fall 2018 **Volunteer**, *43rd Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston University
February 2014 **Volunteer**, *XXIX Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, LSU
April 2013 **Volunteer**, *LXXX SouthEastern Conference on Linguistics (SECOL)*, Spartanburg, SC
February 2012 **Volunteer**, *XXVIII Biennial Louisiana Conference on Hispanic Languages & Literatures*, LSU

Other Service

2014 – 2017 **Co-Organizer**, *Louisiana Association of High School Spanish Clubs' Annual Conference*

Languages

Native	English, Spanish
Elementary	Brazilian Portuguese
Fieldwork	Indonesian, West Greenlandic, Wichita, Yagua, Zulu

Technology

R	●●●●	LaTeX	●●●●
GitHub	●●●●	HTML	●●●●
Python	●●●●	regex	●●●●